

Special Notice (SN) DARPA-SN-25-59
Discover DSO Day (D3)
April 23-24, 2025
Chicago, IL

The Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA) Defense Sciences Office (DSO) is sponsoring a Discover DSO Day (D3) event to (1) familiarize participants with DSO's mission; (2) promote understanding of DSO funding opportunities; and (3) facilitate discussions with DSO program managers. The event will be held in person only on April 23-24, 2025, in Chicago, IL. Advance registration is required for all individuals attending. Note that all deadlines and times listed in this notice and on the registration website are Eastern Time.

To identify and explore ideas that could potentially revolutionize the state of the art, DARPA strongly encourages participation by small businesses, academic and research institutions, and first-time Government contractors (e.g., non-traditional proposers) in events such as this and any subsequent solicitation.

DSO OBJECTIVE AND DESCRIPTION

DARPA seeks to identify and pursue high-impact research initiatives across a broad spectrum of science and engineering disciplines for the U.S. Department of Defense. The objective of this event is to connect DSO with the science and technology community to help generate world-leading technologies and capabilities for U.S. national security, which is critical to the Office's mission of creating and preventing scientific surprise. DARPA DSO focuses on nascent and emergent technologies that may result in breakthrough capabilities for U.S. national security applications and the demonstration of the potential of these technologies through targeted development efforts.

DSO research opportunities are broadcast through a variety of mechanisms, including program solicitations such as Broad Area Announcements (BAAs), Disruption Opportunities (DOs), and Advanced Research Concepts (ARCs). DARPA designed these opportunities to enable the global research community to pursue breakthrough ideas while understanding that such ideas often include substantial technical risks.

DSO is interested in engaging with the broad research and development community to tackle complex challenges and validate impactful research concepts and ideas that address DARPA's mission and lead to transformative capabilities.

REGISTRATION INFORMATION

The D3 event will be held on April 23-24, 2025, in Chicago, IL. Interested participants may register to attend one or both days. The registration fee to participate on day 1 is \$165, and the day two registration fee is \$110. A tentative agenda is included below, and additional details are provided on the registration website.

Registration opens: As of publication of this announcement.

Registration website: <https://events.sa-meetings.com/D3Apr2025>

Registration closes: April 8, 2025, at 5:00 p.m., or when capacity is reached, whichever comes first.

Advance registration via the above website is required to attend the D3 event in-person. Due to the limitations of the conference facility space, in-person attendance is restricted to the first 250 registrants with a maximum of five (5) individuals from any one organization and no more than two (2) representatives per division/department of that organization. Interested

parties are encouraged to coordinate attendance internally within their organizations prior to registration. DARPA may modify the in-person organization restriction as needed.

Registrants in excess of the maximum capacity limitations may be added to a waitlist. If slots become available due to cancellations, DARPA may fill the slots on a first-come, first-served basis from the waitlist.

ELIGIBILITY

DARPA is hosting D3 and similar events to (1) promote teaming arrangements between researchers; (2) provide potential proposers with information on whether and how they might respond to the Government's research and development solicitations; and (3) increase efficiency in proposal preparation and evaluation. Therefore, this event is only open to registered potential proposers to DSO research opportunities (i.e., the event is closed to the general public and media). D3 event registration is open to potential proposers who are U.S. citizens, U.S. permanent residents, and foreign nationals.

All registrants who are not U.S. citizens must complete and submit either a DARPA Form 60, "U.S. Permanent Resident and Foreign National Visit Request," (e.g., industry or academia) or an Official Visit Request (foreign government personnel only) through their country's embassy based in Washington, DC, no later than 5:00 p.m. on April 8, 2025. Form 60 submission instructions are provided in the registration confirmation email. Contact your embassy staff for assistance in submitting the Official Visit Request. Upon entry to the event, all attendees must present valid, Government-issued photo identification.

Q & A

Administrative questions about the D3 event should be emailed to discoverdsoday2025@darpa.mil. All questions must be in English and must include the name and email address of a point of contact.

CONTACT INFORMATION

Please refer to Discover DSO Day in the subject line of all correspondence.

- Administrative Point of Contact: discoverdsoday2025@darpa.mil
- Registration Website: <https://events.sa-meetings.com/D3Apr2025>
- DARPA/DSO Opportunities Website: <https://www.darpa.mil/about/offices/dso#opportunities>

DISCLAIMERS AND IMPORTANT NOTES

Attendance at the D3 event is voluntary and is not required to propose to any DARPA DSO solicitation. Interested parties to this notice are cautioned that nothing herein obligates the Government to issue a solicitation. D3 does not constitute a formal solicitation for proposals or abstracts. This announcement is issued solely for information and program planning purposes and is not a Request for Information (RFI). Since this is not an RFI, the Government will not accept submissions against this notice. No classified, International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR) controlled, or proprietary information shall be presented by the Government at D3. DARPA will not reimburse costs incurred to participate in D3. Recording this event is not permitted.

DISCOVER DSO DAY AGENDA*

April 23, 2025

8:00 – 9:00	Registration/Check-in
9:00 – 9:15	Welcome and DARPA overview
9:15 – 9:45	Defense Sciences Office (DSO) Overview
9:45 – 10:05	Impact of DSO programs
10:05 – 10:20	Break
10:20 – 11:20	Working with DARPA: Contracts Management Office, DARPAConnect Working at DARPA: Program Managers, Fellows, and SETAs (Scientific Engineering Technical Advisor)
11:30 – 1:30	Lunch & Program Manager Poster Session/Networking
1:30 – 2:10	Guest speaker
2:15 – 2:45	Future of sensing
2:45 – 3:25	Panel: Opportunities and challenges in sensing
3:25 – 3:40	Break
3:40 – 4:10	New approaches to computation and processing
4:10 – 4:50	Panel: Unique defense challenges for computation and processing
5:00 – 6:30	Networking session/reception

April 24, 2025

8:00 – 9:00	Registration/Check-in
9:00 – 9:40	Guest speaker
9:45 – 10:15	Resilience, reliability, and availability of capability
10:15 – 10:55	Panel: Enabling operations in challenging environments
10:55 – 11:10	Break
11:10 – 11:55	Panel: Lowering the barrier to entry for working with DARPA: Advanced Research Concepts and Young Faculty Award
12:00 – 12:30	Panel: Accelerating transition from bench to battlefield
12:30 – 2:30	Lunch & Innovation Fellow Poster Session/Networking
2:30 – 3:00	New approaches to energy and access
3:00 – 3:40	Panel: Transport and energy needs
3:45 – 4:05	New vectors for DSO
4:10 – 4:25	Closing remarks
4:25	Adjourn

*Agenda is subject to change.